

THE SURVEY
OF
WESTERN PALESTINE.

ARABIC AND ENGLISH NAME LISTS

COLLECTED DURING THE SURVEY BY

LIEUTENANTS CONDER AND KITCHENER, R.E.

TRANSLITERATED AND EXPLAINED BY

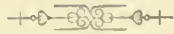
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FOR
THE COMMITTEE OF THE PALESTINE EXPLORATION FUND,
1, ADAM STREET, ADELPHI, LONDON, W.C.
1881.

P R E F A C E.



THESE Lists were originally put together by Lieutenant Conder, but I have revised the Arabic spelling from careful comparison with the field books and the notes of the native scribe. For the English definitions I am myself responsible. The transliteration I have been obliged to leave untouched, as it was already finally engraved upon the Map before I took the matter in hand. The Committee had decided upon the adoption of Robinson's system, which has, however, only been partially followed, no difference being made between the equivalents for the cognate Arabic letters س and ص, ك and ق &c. ; still it fairly represents the sound of the Arabic words in English ; and as they are given in Arabic characters as well, this circumstance can occasion no difficulty to scholars. Many of the names were collected by the English members of the party, and submitted to the scribe afterwards, who seems to have written down some conjecturally, the delicate distinction between certain letters not being appreciable to an ordinary European ear. I have endeavoured by careful philological investigation of the words to settle their orthography, and believe that the names will, in most instances, be found correct, though it is quite possible that some may need revision on the spot by an investigator with a practised ear.

To determine the exact meaning of Arabic topographical names is by no means easy. Some are descriptive of physical features, but even these

are often either obsolete or distorted words. Others are derived from long since forgotten incidents, or owners whose memory has passed away. Others again are survivals of older Nabathean, Hebrew, Canaanite, and other names, either quite meaningless in Arabic, or having an Arabic form in which the original sound is perhaps more or less preserved, but the sense entirely lost. Occasionally Hebrew, especially Biblical and Talmudic names, remain scarcely altered; some of these I have indicated; but I have only done so in obvious cases, avoiding mere speculation. The lists will, nevertheless, be found to furnish better data for such researches than any which have hitherto appeared, and future study of them will no doubt reveal much that is of interest, both to philology and Biblical topography.

The Arabic follows the Hebrew letter for letter, except that س *s* in the former generally represents either ש *sh* or ס *s* in the latter; while ش *sh* stands for س *s*; sometimes ع *'ain* appears as ح *h*; ك *k* and כ *kh*, and occasionally ع *'ain* and ا *alif* are also interchanged, in Arabic, but these last are rare. In some instances the modern local form represents the Hebrew with scarcely any change; in others the Hebrew word is simply translated into Arabic, as Dan, "a judge," which appears as *Tell Kâdhi*, "the judge's mound." In others, again, the older form has grown into an intelligible Arabic word, similar in sound, but quite different in meaning, and therefore inapplicable as a descriptive epithet.

The topographical commonplaces, such as رأس *râs*, "a hill-top or headland," Heb. רֹאשׁ *rosh*; عَيْن *'ain*, "a spring," Heb. עֵין *'en*, &c., are for the most part alike in both languages; while such Hebrew or Aramaic words as תִּירָה *tîreh*, "a fort," בִּירָה *bîreh*, "a castle," are often confounded with the Arabic تَير *tair*, "a bird," and بئر *bir*, "a well."

The reader will find in the following pages the meanings of the Arabic words, as far as I could ascertain them, with suggestions as to the more obvious Hebrew and Aramaic derivations. The letters p.n. (proper name) after a name, mean either that it is a common Arabic personal appellation, or that it is a word to which no meaning can be assigned; the former will be at once recognized by the Arabic scholar, the latter will form interesting problems for future investigation.

My previous work in the nomenclature of Sinai and the Tih, has given me the key to many difficulties in Arabic nomenclature, but many still remain unsolved. The names are not mere Arabic words to be translated, but, as I have said, are most varied forms containing multifarious elements, upon which philology alone does not afford us sufficient data to pronounce. All that I could hope to do was to state the certainties, offer suggestions as to the probabilities, and leave the rest to other hands.

E. H. PALMER.

July, 1881.

